Two K-Pop Stars Make Their First Album as a Duo

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Jeonghan and Joshua are singers in Seventeen, a very popular **K-pop** group with 13 members. Now the two have made their own **album** as a **duo** called JxJ. It is called "Dreamscape."

It is Jeonghan's first new music since he finished South Korea's required **military service** this summer. While he was away, he sometimes watched his bandmates perform from the crowd. "I missed those moments on stage," he said.

Joshua spent that time making songs. Jeonghan said he was amazed by Joshua's clear ideas for the **album**.

At first, the two did not agree. Jeonghan wanted a strong sound. Joshua wanted something softer. "Eventually, we met at the middle," Joshua said. Their main song, "12 O'Clock," is a dance song with a **disco** feel.

Joshua grew up in Los Angeles. He said singing as a pair lets him sing much more than in the big group. A tour is planned.

Word Treasure

K-pop -- K-pop is popular music from South Korea.

duo -- A duo is two people who perform together.

album -- An album is a group of songs released together.

military service -- Military service is time spent working in a country's army or armed forces.

disco -- Disco is a style of dance music that was very popular in the 1970s.

Background you need

K-pop groups from South Korea are famous for catchy songs and big dance moves.

Sometimes a few members of a big group team up to make music in a smaller group.

In South Korea, most men must spend time in the military, even famous singers.

Break it down

WHO: Jeonghan and Joshua, singers in the K-pop group Seventeen
WHAT: Made their first album as the duo JxJ, called 'Dreamscape'
WHERE: South Korea, where Seventeen performs
WHY: To show a different side of themselves after Jeonghan's military service

Why it matters

It shows how two friends with different ideas can meet in the middle and make something new.

Test what you remember

1. What group are Jeonghan and Joshua in?

- (A) Barry Loser
- (B) Foo Fighters
- (C) Seventeen
- (D) Red Hot Chili Peppers

2. How many members does Seventeen have?

- (A) 100
- (B) 7
- (C) 2
- (D) 13

3. What is the name of their duo?

- (A) 12 O'Clock
- (B) Carats
- (C) JxJ
- (D) Dreamscape

4. What did Jeonghan finish this summer?

- (A) A painting
- (B) School
- (C) A marathon
- (D) Military service

5. What kind of song is '12 O'Clock'?

- (A) A dance song with a disco feel
- (B) A lullaby
- (C) A country song
- (D) A school song

6. Where did Joshua grow up?

- (A) Seoul
- (B) Los Angeles
- (C) Rome
- (D) London

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: C 2: D 3: C 4: D 5: A 6: B

Questions to think about

1. **Jeonghan: He wanted a strong sound and missed being on stage.**
2. **Joshua: He wanted a softer sound and says they met in the middle.**

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):